

Nokia 8855

Price: Rs 26,999 B-

Although this phone breaks the Rs 18,000 barrier set for the Smart phone category, it still finds itself here. This is because of the limited set of features that this cell phone possesses. We did not think it appropriate to let it compete with the entrants in the Also a phone category.

The 8855, by its very look, is targeted towards the upper segment, business community. Our test unit sported a dull navy blue facade with a thin chrome finish on the periphery of the display, and the sides of the phone. The sliding cover feels flimsy and reveals small, closely packed, chrome finished keys.

The menu is the very simple to use. The cramped keypad affects the typing and the last row of keys are even more difficult to work with since the cover comes in the way.

The 8855 looks stunning, but does not have the features to justify its stratospheric price. It comes with an average address book capacity of 250 and 100 calendar notes. On the messaging front, the phone supports SMS but despite being aimed for the elite, lacks MMS capability. However, concatenated messaging is included. The calendaring features are neat with options of repeating notes—weekly and monthly

view—and it also has the capability of sending notes and schedules—via SMS and IrDA—further enhances the PIM functionality.

On the data connectivity front, the 8855 comes with an IrDA port and an optional cable to connect itself to the PC. The phone has support for WAP 1.1, but lacks high-speed data connectivity support such as GPRS. The phone comes bundled with 32 ring tones that can be personalised, a ring tone composer for composing custom tunes, and four games. Priced at Rs 26,999, it needs a serious price revision to stay in the race.

Siemens C55

Price: Rs 9,400 A-

This cute phone from Siemens tries to break the mould with attractive packaging and looks. The uniqueness of the C55 lies in its integrated sound system.

As apposed to the previous Siemens models that lacked aesthetic appeal, the C55 is miles ahead—the phone has near perfect ergonomics and the oval theme gels well with the overall design cues. The keypad layout, with its plastic keys, is instinctive and has a good touch feedback—a boon for SMS junkies. The covers, for the first time in a Siemens phone, are interchangeable with three simple and elegant hues. The back-lighting can be changed according to the colour of the cover.

The four-way navigational keypad, again a first time feature in the Siemens species, is by far the best in its class. The menu structure remains the same, except for some minor changes, but with the four-way key browsing makes navigating simpler. The C55 has a standard high resolution LCD display capable of displaying four lines of text.

The C55 has enough features to match any other phone in

its class. Apart from the integrated sound system, the phone comes with polyphonic ring tones. It also comes with a sound recorder, so one can record any sound and use it as a ring tone or message alert—try setting a rooster's call for the alarm! The phone comes bundled with two java based games: the remake of the old *Prince of Persia* game and *Arachnoids - Galaxy Hero*. Both the games are playable but slightly slow.

The phone comes with a minimal 50 contact capacity, which is a tad less for this class. It supports up to 765 characters in the SMS, and also has support for EMS. The PIM functionality is very basic with only reminders and a to-do list. The other features include seven profiles, two Java-based applications and other tid bits such as calculator, alarm clock, currency converter and metric converter.

On the data transfer front, the phone is equipped with GPRS for faster connection speed and downloads, and WAP 1.2.1, but lacks IrDA port or any cable connection for data transfer. The phone displayed excellent voice clarity and signal reception.

Priced at Rs 9,400, the C55 phone offers an excellent package with features such as support for Java applications, GPRS support, polyphonic sounds excellent games and good looks. But it still can't beat the price-to-features value of the Sony Ericsson T310, which apart from these features, also offers a colour screen, albeit at the same price.

Sony Ericsson T310

Price: Rs 9,995 A

Additional features for a low price is rare, but this is exactly what Sony Ericsson offers. The T310 is a feature packed phone designed on the lines of the elder sibling the T68i.

The keypad is smartly laid out with a small five-way joystick for menu navigation. Apart from the joystick, two keys are entirely dedicated to the software menu.

The phone has a bright 256-colour LCD display that is capable of displaying five lines of text. Similar to the T68i, it has an icon-based navigation main menu, wherein all features are grouped together under a particular main menu. The grouping of menus was the best we have seen in the entire comparison. Due to the icon-based approach, it does require total attention when browsing. However, shortcut customisation reduces the searching required in the

